Outlook

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Follow-up: can we isolate genuine breaks from posting delay?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Finance and Operations are reconciling the same activity to different days because authorisation, posting and statement dates do not always line up. Failure anecdotes are beginning to drive decisions, although retries and late posting may be making the problem look larger than the affected-customer population.

The questions I would ask in the room are:
1. What would we expect to see if a specific channel is posting outside the expected cut-off?
2. What evidence would instead support that retries or reversals are being counted twice?
3. How do we rule out that most breaks are timing differences?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use June 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards whether matching rules, cut-off times or source ownership must change. A useful output would be a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations; available customer bank statements. One caution: Statements are only available for selected accounts and months; use them as evidence samples, not as the population denominator.

Regards